

Does this make good sense?

How long does this process take:

"They approve the sites real quick vis-à-vis other advertising programmes, considering the large number of applications they get," says Ganesh Siddamali, who runs www.rupya.com, a site that focuses on the Indian stock market including daily performance updates. Rupya.com was approved within a day. However, in some cases, the approval may take as long as seven days.

Step 2: Once your site is approved, you are mailed a link directing you to your account. You can login and customise your ads (pick the colour, placement, and number of cells per ad). Copy the HTML code that's generated and paste it onto your site or template, and sit back... but remember the caveat 'a little bit of effort'.

Add monetary value to your online thoughts! Get money sense... get Google AdSense

Mithun Kidambi

Let's have a small Q & A session. There are three alternatives to pick from. The question is the obvious; which one of these would you choose?

- a) You get a lot of money, but work very hard for it.
- b) You get a decent amount of money with a little bit of effort.
- c) You pluck money off the trees.

The answer is a practical no-brainer. Option [c] is what we all wish could happen. But it seems implausible, as long as the incumbent divine force decides otherwise. Now, if you are working very hard for the money in option [a], chances are you won't get enough time to spend it. That leaves us with option [b], the one option practically everyone chooses.

A universal fact, this has been exploited by various Internet companies. But the big daddy of all new forms of simple innovation is Google. And they have put the above fact into the heart of their AdSense programme.



What Is AdSense?

Small time Web publishers never had it so good.

With falling bandwidth and Web space prices, and now, a free classifieds tool! If you have a small website or a blog, which a clutch of people visit regularly, then you could make some money out of it.

After we are clear with what this AdSense is all about we shall jump to next obvious question—how much money can I make, followed by how much more?

A few details on how to start the programme can be roughly divided into two-steps:

Step 1: You register with Google for the programme. Give them the URL of the site where you want the ads... and wait.

What happens behind the scenes: Once you do this, Google's bots pay you a visit. Reminds you of the *Matrix*? Anyway, these guys crawl all over your site collecting relevant information. Once the information is evaluated, your site/blog is approved or rejected.

What are the criteria for approval: The approval/rejection is based on the site's content and quality. AdSense does not accept sites, which contain porn or promote the use of tobacco and drugs. If your site steers clear of these then it's likely that your application would be approved.



Money Matters

Now that you have the banner or footer or any of the other ad placements done how do you pull in the money? The process is really simple—click the ads to rake in the moolah and increase the page-views of your site.

How long does it take for the first cheque to come into your account? Google starts paying you once you have crossed the \$100 mark. According to Babychen Mathew, editor of www.dancewithshadows.com, a news and current affairs Web site, "It takes around four months for the first payment to come in. That's if you have a fairly decent number of visitors, say, around 10,000 a month." Others like Siddamali, whose site deals in Indian stock market news and figures at the top of a lot of searches, got their first payment within a month.



Trial And Error

Your site's content decides the type of ads that feature on them. All ads do not pay the same. The amount varies from as low as five cents per click, per ad, to as much as \$5 per click. The well paying ads are mostly tourism, pharmaceuticals and online